



Ongoing Violations and Public Safety Concerns at Short Term Rental Adjacent to Our Property

1 message

Michael Woodcock

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To: chairman@chathamcounty.org, deankicklighter@yahoo.com

Dear County Representatives,

I am submitting this complaint regarding the short-term rental located next to our home, at 8611 Whitefield Ave, Savannah GA, 31406. It is viewable online at the following locations:

1. <https://www.airbnb.com/rooms/968055333278851023>
2. www.vrbo.com/3799837
3. www.bookl.ee/cozy-corner-rentals

The operation of this STR has repeatedly disrupted the residential character of our neighborhood and interfered with the quiet enjoyment of our neighborhoods' properties, with numerous violations of the standards outlined in the Chatham County Short-Term Rental Ordinance.

1. Noise, Parties, and Police Response

There have been multiple late-night parties extending into early morning hours, several of which required police involvement. In one instance, guests informed us they planned to host a party; approximately 25 vehicles arrived at 11 PM, and the gathering became loud and disorderly. You'll also notice from the images in the links, the properties have been equipped with party amenities, and ever since, they have drawn very rowdy crowds.

2. Illegal and Unsafe Parking

The STR does not have adequate parking capacity for the guests he allows over the legal occupancy limit. Guests routinely park in prohibited areas, including a nearby church lot clearly marked "Parking for Church Only - Tow Away Zone" and left lots of trash and litter behind on church property. Guests have also driven across our lawn, sinking in axle deep, causing damage, leaving ruts, and requiring wrecker recovery at 2am on a work night. This demonstrates the owner is not adhering to standards requiring a parking diagram, and there is insufficient parking for his guests.

3. Trespass and Safety Concerns

Guests have walked through our yard, shining flashlights into our windows because they were confused about where to go. This has created significant safety concerns for our household, especially considering the violent past with parties at the Airbnb property.

4. Serious Public Safety Incidents

A shooting occurred at this STR, with multiple homes and a vehicle struck by gunfire, as reported by local news. This incident has deeply affected the sense of safety and well-being in our neighborhood. The owner still allows parties on his properties. Police have responded to multiple calls for things ranging from "alcohol overdose" to "Marijuana use complications", and of course the shootings. While they've always been helpful and sympathetic, it does not act as a deterrent of future behavior when there's different guests every night, and as a community we shouldn't have to waste resources policing short term rentals.

5. Occupancy Violations

The owner advertises the property as sleeping 10 guests, despite having only 3 bedrooms. Under County rules (two adults per bedroom plus two additional adults), the maximum legal occupancy is 8. Advertising and hosting above this limit is a direct violation of the STR ordinance.

6. Failure to Prevent Nuisance

The cumulative issues: noise, illegal parking, property damage, trespass, excessive occupancy, and a major violent incident show that the owner is not meeting the ordinance requirement to prevent nuisance or protect the quiet enjoyment of neighboring properties.

Request for County Review

We respectfully request that the County and all relevant agencies review this STR for compliance with occupancy limits, parking requirements, and nuisance prevention obligations, and take any enforcement action deemed appropriate.

Thank you for your attention to this ongoing matter.

Links:

Savannah neighbors react to Airbnb shootout

<https://www.wjcl.com/article/inches-away-savannah-neighbors-react-to-bullets-flying-through-windows-in-airbnb-shootout/68007975>

Bullets hit nearby homes in short term vacation rental shooting | WSAV-TV

<https://www.wsav.com/news/local-news/bullets-hit-nearby-homes-in-short-term-vacation-rental-shooting/>

Shooting at short-term vacation rental in Chatham County raises concern

<https://www.savannahnow.com/story/news/crime/2025/09/25/shooting-at-short-term-vacation-rental-in-chatham-county-raises-concern/86327015007/>

Latest party:

https://youtu.be/ol7AoVw1P_0

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